Where Is the World Heading?

2026

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NVIDIA is a prime example of a behemoth that can rise and fall. Its secrets are out in the open now. That still leaves the real question open: where is the world heading?

What I learnt from NVIDIA's story is that its bet was simple. GPUs could take on processing that CPUs could not, and NVIDIA made that power programmable. Now it is reaping the fruits. Its strength is seeing the future—next year, the year after, and the year after that—and if it can bring everyone on board, it wins.

The cosmic clock

So where is the world heading? 2026 falls in the second half of Brahma's life, in his 51st year. We are in the Sveta Varaha Kalpa, the first day of that year. Within this day we are in the 7th of 14 Manvantaras, and in the 28th of its 71 Mahayugas. Within the Kali Yuga, this is year 5128. Counted from the start of this kalpa, the year is 1,97,29,49,128—one billion, nine hundred seventy-two million, nine hundred forty-nine thousand, one hundred twenty-eight years.

Where is the world heading? To year 1,97,29,49,129. And ultimately, towards cosmic dissolution. At the end of the kalpa the physical, material world dissolves. The jivas fall dormant, merging into Vishnu until the next cycle. For the length of one kalpa the universe remains dissolved; then the dormant karmas drive creation once again in a new kalpa.

Within this kalpa, manvantara, yuga and samvatsara, though, the world is headed in one direction: towards the top of the food chain.

Everything is capital

Movies, cars, houses, chips, AI, mail, computers, software, electronics, satellites, aeroplanes, jets, missiles, drones, insurance products, banks, plugins, browsers, droughts, food, animals, oil, countries, people, slaves, weapons, guns, coins, gold, silver, concepts, ideas, yoga, fruits, prompts, graphics, imagination, paintings, music, compact discs, Blu-rays, players, vessels, stoves, air conditioners, water purifiers, plastics, chemicals, medicines, survival kits, tents,

tools, lamps, toilets, tubs, shower heads, screws, nuts, glasses, LEDs, LCDs, rockets, telescopes, business logic, data, privacy, cameras, printers, paper, news, articles, lands, islands, planets, moons, suns, switches, adapters, phone cases, bags, guitars, helmets, cushions, phones, mics, sofas, beds, travel plans, entertainment displays, drivers, salaries, wires, copper, metals, books, memory.

That is the last twenty years in a nutshell, and we are heading towards more and more of it. Everyone is a capitalist, capitalising on everything. From the universe down to the microscopic, we are all searching for the next thing to capitalise on. We do not ask whether it is good or bad, useful or destructive, clean or polluting, honest or corrupt, beneficial or harmful—to children, animals, plants, planets, moons, or ourselves. The question is far behind us, the answer is far ahead, and we are stuck in between.

Every mind grabs on to anything it can. People are not just people; people are their minds. And those minds are polluted, stimulated beyond any way back.

So where are we headed? Towards bigger, better, more efficient, more lustrous, shinier, faster, stronger, more powerful, more dominant, ever-growing, sharper, more rigid, lighter, easier, more stable, more capitalisable. Anything that fits these adjectives has a future. We want to fly faster, but safer. We want to strike with weapons without being struck ourselves. We want shields without the burden of carrying them. We want infinite food without worrying about starving the rest of the world. We want intelligence without worrying about who dies for lack of water while it cools our data centres.

Better every year

2026, 2027, 2028, 2029, 2030, 2031, 2032, 2033, 2034, 2035: each year has to be better than the last. Anything that fits that equation survives the year. The rest can rise from its ashes.

My identity as an engineer alone would limit what I see. So I identify first as God, then as a son, a student, a husband, a father, an Indian, an engineer, an IT engineer. Engineering comes near the end. God, son and student come much earlier. That is who I am: a student of this life and this universe, with the universe as my guru. From there, I can see past the filter of bigger, better, faster, more efficient, more powerful, more dominant, shinier, stronger, lighter, easier.

2027 and 2028 demand exactly that of me—of me as a human—and that is what will carry this human forward:

- the most efficient software;
- the most powerful software;
- the largest codebase, encompassing all of human knowledge;
- the largest memory for holding data;
- the smallest chip holding the most data;
- the fastest engine for computing;

- the easiest robot to configure;
- the most encompassing general-purpose platform.